



API Documentation

Features, Functions & REST API Reference

Base URL	<code>https://api.meetup.com/v3</code>
Version	<code>v3.0 May 2026</code>
Format	<code>JSON (application/json)</code>
Auth	<code>OAuth 2.0 (Bearer Token)</code>

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1. App Overview

Meetup is a social platform that connects people around shared interests. It enables organizers to create local or virtual groups around topics like technology, fitness, arts, business, and more — allowing members to discover, RSVP, and attend events in their area or online.

Property	Value
Base URL	https://api.meetup.com/v3
Data Format	application/json
Version	v3 (current stable)
Auth	OAuth 2.0 — Bearer Token
Rate Limit	200 req/hr (Standard)

2. Core Features & Functions

Groups

Create & Manage Groups	Organizers create groups around any topic, configure privacy (public/private), and manage membership rules.
Group Topics & Categories	Groups are tagged with topics (e.g. Python, Hiking) and placed under broader categories like Tech or Fitness.
Group Roles	Three roles: organizer (full admin), co-organizer (manage events & members), and member.
Membership Approval	Groups can be open (anyone joins), closed (approval required), or invitation-only.
Group Dues	Organizers can charge recurring membership dues via Stripe integration.
Group Branding	Custom cover photos, logos, and bios for each group.
Announcements	Organizers broadcast messages to all members instantly.

Group Discussions	Members post threaded discussions on the group message board.
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Events

Create Events	Title, description, date/time, location (in-person or online), max attendees, RSVP deadline.
Recurring Events	Support for weekly, biweekly, or monthly recurring event series.
Event Visibility	Public, members-only, or unlisted events.
Venue Management	Attach venue with address and map, or set as online with Zoom/Meet link.
Waitlists	Auto-promote attendees from waitlist when spots open.
Event Fees	Charge per-attendee fees via Stripe with optional refund policies.
Check-in	Organizers check in attendees via QR code or manual check-in.
Reminders	Automated reminders sent 24 hours and 1 hour before the event.
Cancellation	Cancel events with an auto-notification to all RSVPed members.
Draft Events	Save events as drafts before publishing.

Members & Profiles

- Profile with bio, photo, location, topics of interest, and membership history.
- Social links: Twitter, LinkedIn, and other platforms.
- Member badges earned for milestones (First Event, 10 Events Attended, etc.).
- Follow other members to see their upcoming events.
- Control profile visibility, attendance history, and group membership privacy.
- Manage email preferences, notification settings, and payment methods.

Discovery & Search

- Location-based discovery: find groups and events near a city, zip, or GPS coordinates.
- Topic & Category Browsing: browse by interest (Tech, Outdoors, Arts, etc.).
- Full-text keyword search across groups, events, and members.
- Personalised group recommendations based on interests and location.
- Upcoming events feed from joined and recommended groups.
- Online Events Filter: show only virtual events accessible from anywhere.

Notifications

- Push Notifications: new events, reminders, RSVP updates, messages.
- Email Notifications: configurable daily/weekly digests and transactional emails.
- In-App Notification Centre for all platform activity.

Messaging

- Group Chat: real-time group message threads for organizers and members.
- Direct Messages: 1:1 messaging between any two members.
- Organizer Blast: message all RSVPed attendees for a specific event.

Payments

- Stripe Connect integration — all payments processed securely.
- Recurring group dues set by the organizer.
- Per-event ticketing with customisable refund policies.
- Organizer payout management via Stripe Dashboard.
- Full or partial refund issuance through the organizer dashboard.

Analytics Dashboard

- Event Attendance Trends: RSVP and attendance charts over time.
- Member Growth: new member graph by week/month.
- Engagement Metrics: comments, photo uploads, discussion activity.
- Revenue Reports: dues and event fee revenue summaries.
- RSVP Export: download attendee list as CSV.

3. API Documentation

All API requests must include an Authorization: Bearer {ACCESS_TOKEN} header unless stated otherwise. The base URL for all endpoints is `https://api.meetup.com/v3`.

Authentication (OAuth 2.0)

Meetup uses the Authorization Code grant flow. Redirect users to the authorization URL, exchange the returned code for tokens, and refresh as needed.

Step 1 — Authorization Request

```
GET https://secure.meetup.com/oauth2/authorize ?client_id={CLIENT_ID} &response_type=code
&redirect_uri={REDIRECT_URI} &scope=basic+event_management+group_edit+rsvp+reporting
&state={RANDOM_STATE_STRING}
```

Step 2 — Exchange Code for Token

```
POST https://secure.meetup.com/oauth2/access Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded
client_id={CLIENT_ID}&client_secret={CLIENT_SECRET}
&grant_type=authorization_code&redirect_uri={REDIRECT_URI}&code={CODE}
```

Response:

```
{ "access_token": "eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiJ9...", "token_type": "bearer", "expires_in": 3600,
"refresh_token": "def502003d9a...", "scope": "basic event_management group_edit rsvp reporting"
}
```

Step 3 — Refresh Token

```
POST https://secure.meetup.com/oauth2/access Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded
client_id={CLIENT_ID}&client_secret={CLIENT_SECRET}
&grant_type=refresh_token&refresh_token={REFRESH_TOKEN}
```

OAuth Scopes

Scope	Description
basic	Read member profile & group info
event_management	Create, edit, and delete events
group_edit	Manage group settings and members
rsvp	RSVP to events on behalf of member

Scope	Description
reporting	Access analytics and attendance data
messaging	Send and read messages
profile_edit	Edit member profile

Groups API

GET	/groups/{urlname}	Get a group by URL name
GET	/groups	List groups near a location
POST	/groups	Create a new group
PATCH	/groups/{urlname}	Update group details
DELETE	/groups/{urlname}	Delete a group
GET	/groups/{urlname}/members	List group members

GET /groups/{urlname} — Query Parameters

No query parameters. Path parameter:

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
urlname	string	Yes	The group's unique URL slug

GET /groups — Query Parameters

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
lat	float	No	Latitude of search centre
lon	float	No	Longitude of search centre
city	string	No	City name (alternative to lat/lon)
country	string	No	ISO 3166-1 alpha-2 country code
radius	float	No	Search radius in miles (default 25, max 100)
topic_id	integer	No	Filter by topic ID
category	integer	No	Filter by category ID
page	integer	No	Results per page (default 20, max 200)
offset	integer	No	Pagination offset
order	string	No	id name newest members

POST /groups — Request Body

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
name	string	Yes	Group name (max 60 chars)
urlname	string	Yes	Unique URL slug (lowercase, hyphens only)
description	string	Yes	Group description (HTML allowed, max 3000)
city	string	Yes	City name
country	string	Yes	ISO country code
state	string	No	State/province (required for US/CA)
join_mode	string	No	open closed approval
visibility	string	No	public private
topics	array	No	Array of topic IDs
category_id	integer	No	Category ID

Events API

GET	/events/{eventId}	Get a single event
GET	/groups/{urlname}/events	List events for a group
POST	/groups/{urlname}/events	Create a new event
PATCH	/events/{eventId}	Update an event
POST	/events/{eventId}/cancel	Cancel an event
DELETE	/events/{eventId}	Delete an event
GET	/events	List upcoming events near location

POST /groups/{urlname}/events — Request Body

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
name	string	Yes	Event title (max 80 chars)
description	string	Yes	Event description (HTML, max 4000 chars)
time	integer	Yes	Unix timestamp in milliseconds (UTC)
duration	integer	No	Duration in ms (default 10800000 = 3hrs)
venue_id	integer	No	Venue ID — omit for online events
is_online_event	boolean	No	true for virtual events
online_event_url	string	No	Meeting link (Zoom, Meet, etc.)
rsvp_limit	integer	No	Max attendees (0 = unlimited)
rsvp_close_offset	string	No	Offset before RSVPs close e.g. "-1d"
publish_status	string	No	published draft
guest_limit	integer	No	Max guests per attendee (default 0)
hosts	array	No	Array of member IDs to set as hosts

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
fee	object	No	Fee configuration object

Fee Object Fields

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
amount	float	Yes	Fee amount
currency	string	Yes	ISO 4217 code e.g. USD
description	string	No	Shown to attendees
required	boolean	No	Whether payment is required to RSVP
refund_policy	string	No	no_refunds partial full

GET /groups/{urlname}/events — Query Parameters

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
status	string	No	upcoming past draft cancelled
page	integer	No	Results per page (default 20, max 200)
offset	integer	No	Pagination offset
no_earlier_than	string	No	ISO 8601 datetime — exclude earlier events
no_later_than	string	No	ISO 8601 datetime — exclude later events
desc	boolean	No	Sort descending if true

Members API

GET	/members/self	Get authenticated member's profile
GET	/members/{memberId}	Get a member by ID (public data only)
PATCH	/members/self	Update current member's profile
GET	/members/self/groups	List groups the member belongs to

PATCH /members/self — Request Body (all optional)

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
name	string	No	Display name
bio	string	No	Profile bio (max 250 chars)
city	string	No	City name
country	string	No	ISO country code
state	string	No	State/province
zip	string	No	Postal code
topics	array	No	Array of topic IDs
photo_id	integer	No	ID of an already-uploaded photo

RSVPs API

GET	/events/{eventId}/rsvps	List RSVPs for an event
POST	/events/{eventId}/rsvps	Create or update an RSVP
DELETE	/events/{eventId}/rsvps/{memberId}	Cancel a member's RSVP
POST	/events/{eventId}/checkins	Check in a member at an event

GET /events/{eventId}/rsvps — Query Parameters

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
response	string	No	yes no waitlist
page	integer	No	Results per page (default 20, max 200)
offset	integer	No	Pagination offset

POST /events/{eventId}/rsvps — Request Body

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
response	string	Yes	yes no
guests	integer	No	Number of guests (default 0)
opt_to_pay	boolean	No	Opt into paying the event fee

Example RSVP Response

```
{ "id": "rsvp_001", "event": { "id": "evt_abc123", "name": "Monthly Python Meetup" }, "member": { "id": 11223344, "name": "Omar Allouni" }, "response": "yes", "guests": 1, "waitlisted": false, "created": 1715100000000, "updated": 1715100000000 }
```

Comments API

GET	/events/{eventId}/comments	Get comments for an event
POST	/events/{eventId}/comments	Post a comment on an event
DELETE	/comments/{commentId}	Delete a comment
POST	/comments/{commentId}/likes	Like a comment

POST /events/{eventId}/comments — Request Body

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
comment	string	Yes	Comment text (max 2000 chars)
in_reply_to	integer	No	Comment ID this is a reply to

Photos API

GET	/events/{eventId}/photos	Get photos for an event
POST	/events/{eventId}/photos	Upload a photo (multipart/form-data)
DELETE	/photos/{photoId}	Delete a photo

POST /events/{eventId}/photos — Form Fields

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
photo	file	Yes	Image file (JPEG/PNG, max 10 MB)
caption	string	No	Photo caption (max 200 chars)

Categories & Topics

GET	/categories	List all categories
GET	/topics	List/search topics

GET /topics — Query Parameters

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
search	string	No	Keyword to search topics by name
category	integer	No	Filter topics by category ID
page	integer	No	Results per page (default 50, max 200)

Sample Category List

1	Arts & Culture	20	Movies & Film
2	Career & Business	21	Music
4	Community & Environment	23	Outdoors & Adventure
5	Dancing	26	Parents & Family
6	Education & Learning	27	Pets & Animals
8	Fitness	28	Photography
10	Food & Drink	29	Religion & Spirituality
11	Games	31	Sci-Fi & Fantasy
13	Health & Wellbeing	32	Social
14	Hobbies & Crafts	33	Sports & Recreation
15	Language & Ethnic Identity	34	Technology
16	LGBTQ+	35	Writing

Search & Discovery

GET	/search	Search groups and events by keyword + location
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GET /search — Query Parameters

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
q	string	Yes	Search keyword
type	string	No	groups events all (default: all)
lat	float	No	Latitude for location-based results
lon	float	No	Longitude for location-based results
radius	float	No	Radius in miles (default 25)
category	integer	No	Filter by category ID
is_online	boolean	No	Include/exclude online-only results
page	integer	No	Results per page (default 20)
offset	integer	No	Pagination offset

Notifications API

GET	/members/self/notifications	List notifications for current member
PATCH	/notifications/{notification Id}	Mark a notification as read
POST	/members/self/notifications/read_all	Mark all notifications as read

Payments & Dues API

GET	/groups/{urlname}/dues	Get group dues settings
PATCH	/groups/{urlname}/dues	Update group dues settings
GET	/members/self/payments	Get payment history for current member
POST	/payments/{paymentId}/refund	Issue a refund

PATCH /groups/{urlname}/dues — Request Body

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
active	boolean	No	Enable or disable dues
amount	float	No	Dues amount
currency	string	No	ISO 4217 currency code e.g. USD
billing_cycle	string	No	monthly quarterly yearly
grace_period_days	integer	No	Days after due date before access revoked
description	string	No	Description shown to members

4. Error Codes

All errors return a JSON body with code, message, and an optional errors array.

```
{ "code": "invalid_request", "message": "The field 'name' is required.", "errors": [ { "field": "name", "message": "This field is required." } ] }
```

HTTP Status	Code	Description
400	invalid_request	Missing or malformed request parameters
401	unauthorized	Missing or invalid access token
403	forbidden	Authenticated but insufficient permissions
404	not_found	Resource does not exist
409	conflict	Resource already exists (e.g. duplicate urlname)
410	gone	Resource has been deleted
422	unprocessable	Validation error on submitted data
429	rate_limited	Too many requests — see Rate Limiting
500	internal_error	Unexpected server error
503	service_unavailable	API temporarily unavailable

5. Rate Limiting

Rate limits are enforced per access token. The following headers are included in every API response:

```
X-RateLimit-Limit: 200 X-RateLimit-Remaining: 143 X-RateLimit-Reset: 1716224400
```

Tier	Requests / Hour
Standard	200
Partner	1,000
Enterprise	10,000

When rate limited (HTTP 429), back off and retry after the X-RateLimit-Reset Unix timestamp.

6. Webhooks

Meetup can push real-time event notifications to your HTTPS endpoint whenever key platform actions occur.

Register a Webhook

POST	/webhooks	Register a new webhook endpoint
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Parameter	Type	Required	Description
url	string	Yes	HTTPS endpoint to receive POST events
events	array	Yes	Array of event type strings to subscribe to
secret	string	No	Secret key — payloads signed with X-Meetup-Signature

Supported Webhook Event Types

Event Type	Trigger
group.created	New group created
group.updated	Group info updated
group.deleted	Group deleted
event.created	New event published
event.updated	Event details changed
event.cancelled	Event cancelled
event.deleted	Event deleted
rsvp.created	New RSVP submitted
rsvp.updated	RSVP response changed
rsvp.deleted	RSVP cancelled
member.joined	New member joined a group
member.left	Member left a group
comment.created	New comment posted on an event
payment.completed	Payment successfully processed
payment.refunded	Refund issued

Example Webhook Payload (event.created)

```
{ "webhook_id": "wh_001", "type": "event.created", "timestamp": 1715200000000, "data": {
  "event": { "id": "evt_abc123", "name": "Python Workshop: FastAPI", "time": 1718640000000,
    "group": { "id": 1234567, "urlname": "nyc-python-developers" } } } }
```

Signature Verification (Node.js)

```
const crypto = require('crypto'); function verifySignature(payload, signature, secret) { const
  hmac = crypto.createHmac('sha256', secret); hmac.update(payload); const computed = 'sha256=' +
  hmac.digest('hex'); return crypto.timingSafeEqual( Buffer.from(computed),
  Buffer.from(signature) ); } // In your webhook handler: const isValid = verifySignature(
  req.rawBody, req.headers['x-meetup-signature'], process.env.WEBHOOK_SECRET );
```

Manage Webhooks

GET	/webhooks	List all registered webhooks
DELETE	/webhooks/{webhookId}	Delete a webhook